

Authorization rejection: establish the source

Use and boundaries

Use when an authorization is described as rejected or a rejection rate changes. Distinguish local validation, routing/transport errors and explicit downstream declines before interpreting a reason. A locked card, insufficient funds or expired card explanation requires an explicit correlated synthetic issuer response. An aggregate error count or alert title does not establish an individual condition.

The analyst gathers evidence; the Authorization Owner interprets reason semantics. Gateway and Platform Owners investigate mapping/configuration discrepancies. This guide does not change routing, retry a payment or make a card/account claim.

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Key / version	RB-101 / 1.0.0
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Owner	Authorization Owner
Tenant ID	8b860d80-d17f-4e6b-8c48-af35f26a4d61
Status / effective	APPROVED / 2026-10-01
Approver	Knowledge Approver (fictional role)
Scope	authorization
Risks / sources	R01, R18, R20 / E01, E02, E03, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Establish the rejection boundary

Read-only sequence

1. Preserve the E01 service/window/status and error counts. Record whether the window is complete; a count is not a measured decline rate without a denominator.
2. Request E02 for the exact tenant, intent and authorization request. Compare submission state with any local validation result. Do not infer submission from an alert description. Retain missing identifiers as gaps.
3. Request E03 with the correlated request and downstream operation identity. Check explicit outcome, reason and source version. A generic decline supports only generic rejection; absent acknowledgement means the outcome is unknown.
4. Compare effective response-mapping/routing configuration in E10. Use E11 to check bounded dependency/access failures only if the observed window overlaps. An overlapping change is a hypothesis, not proof of causation.

Interpretation and negative checks

Observed boundary	Supported reading	Required exclusion
Local validation stopped submission	Local request rejection	E02 must not show a later correlated submission
Explicit downstream decline/reason	Downstream rejection with that reason	Confirm request identity and mapping version
Transport error without final response	Uncertain outcome	Request authoritative response; do not call it a decline

Different routes or observation windows may explain apparently conflicting counts. Do not merge them into one cause. If E03 disagrees with E02, retain both snapshots and escalate the mapping/identity conflict before presenting a final conclusion.

Advice and verification

Conditional direction

For an explicit downstream reason, describe the bounded observation and cite its record. The owner may review the applicable synthetic response policy; the copilot must not recommend overriding issuer controls. Generic rejection needs better reason evidence before any specific card explanation.

For transport uncertainty, use RB-102. For a suspected mapping/configuration fault, use RB-110 and retain the before/after version IDs. A human-controlled correction must name its owner, approval, validation window and rollback configuration; report approval alone authorizes none of those changes.

Escalation and closure

Send the Authorization Owner the request identity, exact source/window, explicit reason or its absence, mapping version, competing explanation and missing source. Do not include raw sensitive payloads. Closure requires consistent correlated records or an explicitly unresolved result with an accountable evidence request. Compare subsequent observations with the same scope; absence of fresh errors is not proof that earlier requests succeeded.

Current product capability

Only E01 aggregate errors are exposed by current MCP. E02-E11 are future read-only source requirements; request them from the named fictional owner, not a nonexistent console control. Degraded/empty report evidence retains Q6 LOW/null behavior.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: PL-101, RB-102, RB-110.

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